English

Brave New World

a) The motto of the World State is 'Community, Identity, Stability' as we learn in the opening paragraph. How is science used to achieve this goal? All three goals must be addressed in your answer.

b) Using your knowledge of Ford from last lesson as well as the novel, discuss why the World State in Brave New World has chosen Henry Ford to base their calendar on. Discuss the implications of choosing someone like Ford as a godlike figure.

c) Comment on the mood of lines 1 - 3: which words create this mood?

d) Compare this mood with the mood set in lines 41 - 58. What purpose does the style of writing serve here? Comment e.g. on the repeated "; how..." phrases.

e) Who is the narrator of the story? Is the narrator limited or omniscient? Is it a fly-on-the-wall or intrusive narrator?

f) Discuss the claim that the setting in science fiction stories is often more important than characters and that the setting is often treated as a character. To what extent is this theoretical point true for this story?

g) What are the main themes? Is the story warning us about something? And if so, what is it a warning about? Is it:

- human cloning
- predestination and conditioning
- individuality
- control
- the political use of technology
- something else?

Give reasons for your answer and explain which understanding of these themes you are left with.

h) Consider the novel as a product of its time. Which political, cultural and/or technological events and trends from the 1920s and 30s might have inspired Huxley to write the novel?

i) Brave New World is considered a satirical novel. How does the satire reveal itself in Chapter 1? Find 2-3 examples and explain how it works.